

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	28 September 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-1668
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders With Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

This template was used in our brainstorming session to shape ideas for streamlining IT procurement by automating standard laptop orders using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Team gathering: All five team members joined the session (10 minutes preparation, 1 hour collaboration) after sharing relevant information about ServiceNow Service Catalog and Flow Designer.

Set the goal: Focus on removing manual effort from the standard laptop ordering process.

Problem statement (How might we...?):

PROBLEM: How might we automate the ordering and approval of standard laptops in ServiceNow using Flow Designer so that requests are fulfilled faster with less manual work?

Key rules of brainstorming:

- Stay on topic.
- Defer judgment.
- Go for volume.
- Encourage wild ideas.
- Listen to others.
- If possible, be visual.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Brainstorm (10 minutes): Each participant wrote down ideas that address the problem statement.

Participant	Idea 1	Idea 2	Idea 3
KARTHIKA R (Team Leader)	Auto-create a catalog item for standard laptop requests	Auto-approve requests that match the standard laptop model	Send email notification on request submission
BRINDHA S	Trigger flow when a Service Catalog request is submitted	Manager approval only for non-standard specs	Update request state automatically after fulfilment
JANANI P	Create a fulfilment task for the IT hardware team	Check stock/asset availability before ordering	Auto-populate user, department and location details
KANIMOZHI P	Dashboard to track laptop orders and delivery status	Error handling and fallback notification to admin	Reminder alerts for pending approvals
PARAMESHWARI V	Email notification to requester on completion	Use Flow Designer subflows to reuse approval logic	Test the flow with sample requests before go-live

Group ideas (20 minutes): Similar ideas were clustered and each cluster was given a label.

Group / Theme	Ideas Included
Order Intake & Trigger	Trigger flow on catalog request submission; auto-populate user, department and location details; catalog item for standard laptop
Approval Automation	Auto-approve standard laptop requests; manager approval only for non-standard specs; reminders for pending approvals
Fulfilment & Inventory	Create fulfilment task for IT hardware team; check stock/asset availability; update request state after fulfilment
Notifications & Monitoring	Email on submission and completion; error handling with admin alert; dashboard for order and delivery status

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Prioritize (20 minutes): Ideas were placed on an Importance vs Feasibility grid. Importance: which idea would have the most positive impact. Feasibility: which is easier regardless of importance (cost, time, effort, complexity).

Idea	Importance	Feasibility	Priority
Trigger flow on catalog request submission	High	High	1 - Do first
Auto-approve standard laptop requests	High	High	2 - Do first
Create fulfilment task for IT hardware team	High	High	3 - Do first
Email notifications (submission / completion)	Medium	High	4 - Quick win
Update request state automatically	Medium	High	5 - Quick win
Error handling and admin alert	Medium	Medium	6 - Plan next

Idea	Importance	Feasibility	Priority
Stock / asset availability check	High	Medium	7 – Plan next
Order and delivery status dashboard	Low	Medium	8 – Later

Outcome: The flow will start with the request trigger, auto-approval for standard laptops and fulfilment task creation, followed by notifications and status updates. Stock checks, error handling and the dashboard are planned as later enhancements.